

Sunday, 30 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

22° 17°

BIRMINGHAM

Rain

21° 15°

MANCHESTER

Rain

21° 15°

GLASGOW

Showers

16° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **A video has emerged appearing to show a police chase just minutes before a fatal crash on the A66 near Middlesbrough.**

Several police vehicles were reportedly seen pursuing a car three minutes before the collision. This comes after police stated they are not currently linking the crash to a fatal house fire.

CRIME · UK

- 2 **A baby tragically died in hospital after the volume on a crucial monitor was found to be too low.**

A coroner has now urged the manufacturer of the alarms, used at the Royal London Hospital, to make changes to the volume options available. It's a heartbreaking situation.

HEALTH · UK

- 3 **British soldiers could soon be using paragliders to drop behind enemy lines in covert operations.**

The Ministry of Defence is trialling a UK-made system that would allow troops to mount missions without needing aircraft. It sounds like something out of a spy movie!

DEFENCE · UK

- 4 **The hidden danger of the UK's e-bike boom has been highlighted, with 18 deaths now linked to battery fires.**

Fatalities have included people inhaling toxic fumes or becoming trapped inside their burning homes. It's a stark reminder of the importance of fire safety.

SAFETY · UK

- 5 **Celtic and Rangers have been ordered to play their next home Scottish Cup ties behind closed doors.**

This follows fan disorder during last season's games. It's a big blow for supporters of both Old Firm clubs.

FOOTBALL · UK

What's coming up

1 **Charli XCX brought an electrifying performance to Reading Festival, headlining the first night of the 2026 event.**

The British singer delivered an era-spanning set, thrilling festival-goers. Irish rock band Fontaines DC also headlined, making it a night to remember.

ON AIR – Did you make it to Reading Festival this year, or perhaps another big music festival? What was your highlight?

MUSIC · FESTIVAL

2 **Spotify is set to introduce a new label for AI-generated artists and will remove them from recommendations.**

The streaming giant's new feature, rolling out from mid-September, will clearly identify if an artist is AI-generated. It's a move that could change how we discover music.

ON AIR – Would you knowingly listen to music created by AI, or do you prefer to stick to human artists?

MUSIC · FUTURE

3 **Edinburgh is launching a brand new media event, following the news that its long-running TV Festival is moving to Manchester next year.**

The capital is keen to maintain its presence in the industry. It'll be interesting to see what this new event looks like and what it offers.

ON AIR – Do you think Edinburgh can successfully launch a new media event, or will Manchester become the undisputed hub?

TV · FUTURE

4 **A street artist has been offered a job painting one of a 'Dragon's' London offices, after receiving advice from the entrepreneur.**

Nathan Murdoch's talent caught the eye of the Dragon, leading to a fantastic opportunity. It's a great example of talent being recognised!

ON AIR – What's the most unusual job offer you've ever received, or perhaps one you've always dreamed of getting?

ART · SUCCESS

5 **Strictly Come Dancing star Amy Dowden says appearing on Celebrity Hunted showed her she can achieve anything after cancer.**

Amy, who has bravely battled cancer, took part in the Channel 4 challenge show. Her resilience and determination are truly inspiring.

ON AIR – Amy Dowden is such an inspiration! What's a challenge you've overcome that made you feel like you could achieve anything?

TV · INSPIRATION

On the schedule

1 **Manchester City's Rayan Cherki could be on the cusp of a breakthrough season after a dazzling display against Crystal Palace.**

After scoring two goals and showing real swagger, experts are asking if this is Cherki's moment to shine for the Premier League champions. He's been described as a magician!

ON AIR – Is Rayan Cherki the next big star for Manchester City, or is it too soon to make that call?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Harry Kane has been discussing his hopes for the prestigious Ballon d'Or award.**

This comes after he became the first Englishman to win Germany's Footballer of the Year award for the 2025-26 season. Could this be his year?

ON AIR – Do you think Harry Kane has what it takes to win the Ballon d'Or, or is there too much competition?

FOOTBALL · EUROPEAN

3 **Mikaela Mayer and Chantelle Cameron had a heated final face-off before their light-middleweight unification bout in Birmingham.**

The two boxers butted heads, showing the intensity of their rivalry. It promises to be an unmissable fight!

ON AIR – Are you looking forward to the Mayer vs Cameron fight? Who are you backing to win?

BOXING · UK

4 **Aston Villa are set to welcome new striker Nicolas Jackson, with Ollie Watkins looking likely to join Al-Hilal.**

BBC Sport is examining what Jackson will bring to the Villa squad. Watkins' departure will be a big change for the club.

ON AIR – How do you think Nicolas Jackson will fit in at Aston Villa, and will they miss Ollie Watkins?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Norway's Viktor Hovland and American Ryan Gerard are tied for the lead at the Tour Championship, heading into the weekend.**

Both golfers are at 10 under par in Atlanta, setting up an exciting conclusion. It's all to play for!

ON AIR – Who do you think will come out on top in the Tour Championship this weekend?

GOLF · INTERNATIONAL

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that wearing bright colours can genuinely boost your mood and even make others perceive you as more approachable.**
Researchers found that participants who opted for vibrant clothing reported feeling more positive and energetic throughout their day. So, maybe it's time to dig out those colourful jumpers!
- 2 The delightful trend of 'vintage picnic baskets' is making a comeback, with people rediscovering the charm of traditional outdoor dining.**
Instead of disposable bags, many are opting for beautifully woven baskets, complete with proper plates and cutlery, for a more sustainable and stylish al fresco experience.
- 3 Scientists have discovered that the simple act of 'listening to birdsong' can significantly reduce feelings of anxiety and stress.**
Even just a few minutes of listening to natural bird calls can help to calm the mind and improve overall well-being. Perhaps a moment by an open window is all you need.
- 4 There's a lovely movement for 'community recipe swaps' where neighbours share their favourite family dishes and baking secrets.**
It's a wonderful way to connect with others, try new cuisines, and ensure those cherished recipes get passed down and enjoyed by a wider audience.
- 5 New research indicates that having 'indoor plants with broad leaves' can improve air quality and even aid concentration.**
These plants are particularly good at filtering indoor air and creating a more serene environment, making your home or office a healthier place to be.
- 6 A growing number of people are finding joy in 'collecting unique teacups and saucers' as a charming, affordable hobby.**
It's a wonderful way to add a touch of personality to your daily brew, with each cup telling its own little story from car boot sales or antique shops.
- 7 The simple pleasure of 'writing a physical to-do list' is being hailed as a surprisingly effective way to boost productivity and reduce stress.**
The act of physically ticking off tasks is said to provide a greater sense of accomplishment compared to digital lists, making your day feel more manageable.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new type of cheese will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GIVING IT A LITTLE SNIFF AND THEN A TINY, ALMOST IMPERCEPTIBLE SQUEEZE.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, fresh fruit salad, especially if it's a new combination of fruits. What is it?

ANSWER: REARRANGING THE PIECES SO THE COLOURS ARE JUST RIGHT.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a certain 'piece of furniture' or even a specific 'room in your house' just seems to accumulate all the bits and bobs that don't quite belong anywhere else?

Is there a particular corner, a chair, or even a whole room in your home that has become the unofficial 'holding bay' for everything from spare buttons to half-read books? What's the most unusual item that's found its way there?

- We all have those 'little everyday phrases' or local sayings that might sound a bit quirky to someone not from around here.

What's a common phrase or saying from your town or region that you use all the time, but you suspect might leave someone from further afield completely baffled? Let us know your local linguistic gems!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of hedgehogs is called an 'array'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that a group of ladybirds is called a 'kaleidoscope'?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's largest grand piano is over 5 metres long and was built by a New Zealander.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest.
- The shortest war in history lasted only 38 to 45 minutes between Britain and Zanzibar in 1896.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- A cloud can weigh over a million pounds.
- The King of Hearts is the only king in a deck of cards without a moustache.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The first successful photograph of a human was taken in 1838, but the person was getting their shoes shined, so they had to stand still for a long exposure.

On this day

Day 242 of the year, 123 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alexander of Constantinople (Eastern Orthodoxy); Christian feast day: Blessed Alfredo Ildefonso Schuster; Christian feast day: Blessed Eustáquio van Lieshout; Christian feast day: Blessed Stephen Nehmé (Maronite Church / Catholic Church). Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1954 — David Paymer, American actor and director
- 1968 — Diran Adebayo, English author and critic
- 1966 — Michael Michele, American actress
- 1950 — Dana Rosemary Scallon, Irish singer and activist
- 1971 — Lars Frederiksen, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1966 — Peter Cunnah, Northern Irish singer-songwriter and producer
- 1951 — Timothy Bottoms, American actor
- 1985 — Richard Duffy, Welsh footballer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1967 — Thurgood Marshall is confirmed as the first African American Justice of the Supreme Court of the United States.
- 1963 — The Moscow–Washington hotline between the leaders of the U.S. and the Soviet Union goes into operation.
- 2021 — The last remaining American troops leave Afghanistan, ending U.S. involvement in the war.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1936 — The RMS Queen Mary wins the Blue Riband by setting the fastest transatlantic crossing.
- 2021 — The last remaining American troops leave Afghanistan, ending U.S. involvement in the war.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2008 — A Conviasa Boeing 737 crashes into Illiniza Volcano in Ecuador, killing all three people on board.
- 1945 — The Japanese occupation of Hong Kong comes to an end.
-

1974 — The Third World Population Conference ends in Bucharest, Romania. At the end of the ceremony, the UN-Romanian Demographic Centre is inaugurated.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 243 of the year, 122 days left in 2026. Today Baloch-Pakhtun Unity Day (Balochs and Pashtuns, International observance); Christian feast day: Aidan of Lindisfarne; Christian feast day: Amatus of Nusco; Christian feast day: Aristides of Athens. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1979 — Simon Neil, Scottish singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1967 — Gene Hoglan, American drummer
- 1960 — Chris Whitley, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2005)
- 1992 — Holly Earl, British actress
- 1940 — Larry Hankin, American actor, director, and producer
- 1971 — Kirstie Allsopp, British TV presenter
- 1980 — Joe Budden, American broadcaster and former rapper
- 1986 — Ryan Kelley, American actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1959 — A parcel bomb sent by Ngô Đình Nhu, younger brother and chief adviser of South Vietnamese President Ngô Đình Diệm, fails to kill King Norodom Sihanouk of Cambodia.
- 2016 — Brazil's President Dilma Rousseff is impeached and removed from office.
- 1986 — The Soviet passenger liner Admiral Nakhimov sinks in the Black Sea after colliding with the bulk carrier Pyotr Vasev, killing 423.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1988 — Delta Air Lines Flight 1141 crashes during takeoff from Dallas/Fort Worth International Airport, killing 14.
- 2005 — The 2005 Al-Aimma bridge stampede in Baghdad kills 953 people.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
-------	-----------------------

FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
--------	----------------------

FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
--------	-------------------

FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
--------	---------------------

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
--------	---

FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)
--------	-------------------------

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar